

Zest for Life: The Ultimate Citrus Cookbook



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About the NBCF x Sunkist Growers, Inc. Partnership

Sunkist Growers, Inc. joined NBCF as a charitable partner to show their commitment to those facing breast cancer by supporting health and wellness initiatives through their Power with the Pink Orange™ campaign and through generous donations to women and families facing breast cancer. Sunkist continues to support NBCF's mission through providing breast health education to their employees and communities, raising awareness of the importance of early detection, and donating hundreds of products to support those facing a diagnosis.

"Sunkist Growers is honored to partner with National Breast Cancer Foundation. Their mission of Helping Women Now is something our growers and organization are passionate about. We are proud of the vital work they do in inspiring hope for those affected by breast cancer."

- Jim Phillips
President & CEO
Sunkist Growers



Disclaimer: All recipes and photos in this cookbook are courtesy of Sunkist Growers, Inc. and their collaborating partners. The information has been reviewed by NBCF-sourced registered dietitian, [Annie Cavalier, MS, RDN, LD](#). The recipes in this cookbook should serve as a general guide for healthy, citrus-forward meals. Please ask your doctor if there are certain foods that you need to avoid due to other medical conditions, allergies, or nutrient interactions with medications you may be taking before making these recipes. For example, grapefruit can affect how your body metabolizes certain medications and therefore should be avoided when taking those medications.

Zest for Life: The Ultimate Citrus Cookbook



Good nutrition plays a vital role in the cancer recovery process. Whether you're undergoing treatment, recovering, or simply looking to support your health with vibrant, wholesome food, this cookbook offers comforting, easy-to-make recipes filled with the bright flavors of citrus. We have also included several tips from a registered dietitian on ways to personalize these recipes based on symptoms you may be having, personal preferences, or ways to maximize nutrition and overall health.

Citrus fruits such as oranges, grapefruits, and mandarins offer more than just refreshing flavor—they're rich in vitamin C, antioxidants, and fiber, which can support the immune system, reduce inflammation, aid digestion, and may even reduce the risk for cancer and its recurrence.

Whether you're cooking for yourself, a loved one, or your whole family, we hope this cookbook brings you comfort, joy, and a little extra brightness each day.



Breakfast & Drink



Navel Orange & Apple Muffins



Recipe by Anita Parris Soule, Sunkist Collaborator



**Number of
servings: 12**



Prep time:
20 minutes



Cook time:
20 minutes

Approximate Nutrition Facts

Number of servings: 12

Serving size

1 muffin

Calories	234
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Total Fat	14g
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Saturated Fat	8g
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Cholesterol	31mg
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Sodium	206mg
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Total Carbohydrates	26g
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Fiber	3.3g
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Sugars	8g
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Protein	5g
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Not only are Navel oranges packed with flavor, they also pack a punch when it comes to nutrition! In fact, one Navel orange contains approximately 90% of your recommended daily intake of vitamin C,^[1] a nutrient that helps support the immune system and promote wound healing by helping with the production of collagen.^[2] The sweetness of these Navel Orange and Apple Muffins comes from the natural sugars in the orange juice, applesauce, and raisins, rather than relying purely on added sugars, which do not provide much nutritional benefit.

Ingredients

- 2 cups whole wheat flour (or pastry flour if available)
- 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/4 tsp kosher salt
- 1/4 tsp ground cinnamon
- 2 eggs
- 1 Navel orange, zest
- 1/4 Navel orange, juiced
- 1 cup apple sauce
- 1 cup grated apple
- 1/2 cup coconut oil, melted
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 cup chopped walnuts or pecans (optional)
- 1/2 cup raisins (optional)

Instructions

1. Preheat oven to 375° F. Line a 12-count muffin pan with paper liners or spray generously with nonstick baking spray.
2. In a large bowl, whisk flour, baking powder, baking soda, cinnamon, and salt together.
3. Make a space in the center of the flour mixture and add eggs, orange zest, orange juice, apple sauce, grated apple, melted coconut oil, and vanilla.
4. Whisk together gently to combine and fold in nuts and raisins if using.
5. Spoon or scoop batter into muffin pan, filling all the way to the top.
6. Bake in preheated oven, 20 minutes for regular muffins or 15 minutes for mini muffins, until a toothpick inserted into center of muffin comes out clean.

Nutrition Tips & Substitution Options

- Feel free to add 1-2 servings of vanilla protein powder in step #2 to bump up the protein content a bit! You can also have the muffin as a side with your choice of protein.
- You can reduce the amount of carbohydrates in this recipe by using an apple sauce with zero grams of added sugars.
- If you want an even stronger orange taste, feel free to include Navel orange slices in the muffins! This will also squeeze in a little more of that vitamin C.

Orange Spiced Tea



Recipe by Sunkist



**Number of
servings:** 2



Prep time:
8 minutes



Cook time:
10 minutes

Approximate Nutrition Facts

Number of servings: 2

Serving size

Approx. 1 cup

Calories	90
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Total Fat	0g
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Saturated Fat	0g
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Cholesterol	0mg
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Sodium	7mg
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Total Carbohydrates	23g
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Fiber	1g
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Sugars	21g
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Protein	0g
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If you're experiencing nausea (as a result of cancer treatment or something else), sipping hot tea may provide some relief. Many individuals find it not only soothing but also a gentle way to stay hydrated. The smell of citrus can also help ease queasiness—so why not combine both approaches? This Orange Spiced Tea blends comforting warmth with uplifting citrus aromas, offering a calming way to settle both your stomach and your mind, whether you're in treatment or simply in need of a little comfort.

Ingredients

2 cups water

1/3 clove of cinnamon,
or 1/2 teaspoon ground cinnamon

2 tea bags

1/3 cup Navel orange juice

2 1/2 Tbsp white sugar, optional

2 tsp lemon juice

2 Navel orange slices

Instructions

1. Bring water and cinnamon to a boil and let cinnamon dissolve.
2. Remove from heat and add tea bags to water to soak for at least 5 minutes. Remove tea bags.
3. Meanwhile, in a separate pan, add orange juice, sugar, and lemon juice and bring to a boil.
4. Stir until the sugar dissolves.

5. Pour juice mixture into the spiced tea.
6. Garnish with 1 slice of Navel orange.
7. Serve hot.

Nutrition Tips & Substitution Options

- Because the orange juice adds natural sweetness, you can cut back on or even skip the white sugar for a healthier option. Alternatively, you can use honey in place of sugar—because honey is slightly sweeter than table sugar, a smaller amount will still provide the same level of sweetness.
 - » If you are undergoing chemotherapy or immunotherapy, be sure to avoid raw honey (the label will specify if it is raw), as it may contain bacteria that could pose a risk to a weakened immune system.
- Feel free to use caffeine-free tea if desired.
- If you're dealing with mouth sores (a common side effect of some cancer treatments), the acidity in orange or lemon juice may cause irritation. In that case, try sipping on a mild ginger or peppermint tea instead, and be sure it's warm, not hot, to avoid further discomfort.



Lunch & Snack



Grapefruit Grain Salad with Red Wine Vinaigrette



Recipe by Kristan Raines, Sunkist Collaborator



**Number of
servings: 4**



Prep time:
20 minutes



Cook time:
5 minutes

Approximate Nutrition Facts

Number of servings: 4

Serving size

Approx. 1 1/4 cups

Calories	412
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Total Fat	17g
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Saturated Fat	4g
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Cholesterol	13mg
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Sodium	450mg
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Total Carbohydrates	60g
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Fiber	7g
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Sugars	16g
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Protein	10g
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Grapefruit contains high levels of cancer-fighting nutrients, including vitamin C, beta-carotene (which your body uses to make vitamin A), and lycopene (a powerful antioxidant). Also high in fiber, grapefruit can help maintain a healthy weight, boost your immune system, and protect against inflammation.^[3]

Couscous is a grain-like pasta made from semolina flour that is rich in selenium, a powerful antioxidant that helps boost the immune system, repair damaged cells, and may lower cancer risk.^[4] With these two superfoods combined, this salad makes for one healthy lunch!

Ingredients

Grapefruit Grain Salad

- 1 cup dry couscous
- 1 cup water
- 1/2 tsp sea salt
- 8 oz sugar peas, thinly sliced
- 2 oz feta cheese, plus extra for garnish
- 2 1/2 Tbsp chopped mint, plus extra for garnish
- 3 supreme California Star Ruby grapefruits

Red Wine Vinaigrette

- 2 Tbsp red wine vinegar
- 1/2 tsp Dijon mustard
- 1 garlic clove, minced
- 1/2 tsp agave, optional
- 4 Tbsp olive oil
- Salt and pepper, to taste

Instructions

1. Begin by preparing the couscous. Place the water and salt into a saucepan and set over medium heat. Once the water begins to boil, mix in the couscous, cover with a lid, and remove from heat.
2. Let the couscous rest for 5 minutes, or until all the water has been absorbed. Remove the lid and gently fluff with a fork. Let cool.
3. For the dressing, add the red wine vinegar, mustard, garlic, agave, and a pinch of salt and pepper to a small bowl. Whisk everything together to combine.
4. While whisking, slowly pour in the olive oil. Continue whisking until all of the olive oil has been added. Taste, and add additional salt or pepper as needed. Set the dressing aside.
5. To a large bowl, add the cooled couscous, sugar peas, feta cheese, and mint. Drizzle your dressing or vinaigrette of choice over the top and toss together until everything is well coated.
6. Add the grapefruit segments and gently toss a few more times to incorporate. Garnish salad with a bit more mint and feta cheese and enjoy.

Nutrition Tips & Substitution Options

- To make this salad dairy-free, use a dairy-free feta cheese alternative. Just be mindful if you have any other dietary restrictions, as these often contain either nuts, gluten, or soy.
- Add your choice of protein (chicken, fish, shrimp, boiled egg, etc) to make it a well-balanced meal.
- Grapefruit does interact with some medications—ask your doctor if there are any foods you need to avoid based on the medications you have been prescribed.

Mandarin Orange Chicken Salad



Recipe by Stephanie Grasso, RD, Sunkist Collaborator



**Number of
servings: 6**



**Prep time:
15 minutes**

Approximate Nutrition Facts

Number of servings: 6

Serving size

Approx. 2 cups

Calories	478
-----------------	------------

Total Fat	19g
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Saturated Fat	5g
---------------	----

Cholesterol	188mg
--------------------	-------

Sodium	948mg
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Total Carbohydrates	34g
----------------------------	-----

Fiber	3.5g
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Sugars	28g
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Protein	46g
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Like most citrus, mandarins are full of vitamins and fiber and are rich in antioxidants, which can help protect against cancer by suppressing genes that support cancer growth and neutralizing free radicals, which may otherwise damage your cells and promote cancer.^[5] Likewise, cranberries contain lots of vitamin C, and they are one of the best sources of another antioxidant known as quercetin, which has been shown to reduce the risk of cancer. Quercetin can also promote brain health and help reduce blood pressure.^[6] Cranberries contain a unique compound called A-type proanthocyanidins, which can help promote bladder and urinary health.^[7] This delicious chicken salad is also high in protein, making it a great way to pack multiple health benefits into one meal.

Ingredients

2 pounds rotisserie chicken, boneless, skinless, chopped

7 celery stalks, chopped

1 1/2 cup Greek yogurt, plain

5 mandarins, peeled and segmented

3 Tbsp stone ground Dijon mustard

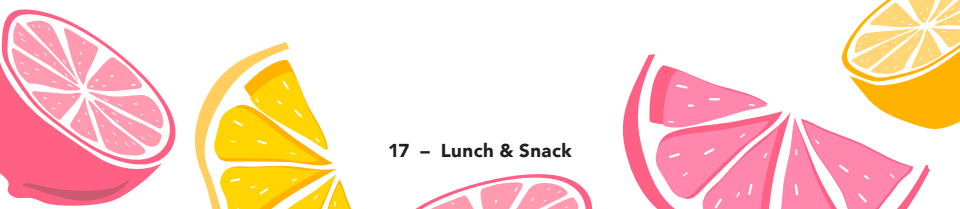
1 cup dried cranberries

1/4 tsp salt

1/4 tsp pepper

Instructions

1. Combine and stir together chicken, celery, Greek yogurt, mustard, salt, and pepper.



2. Add segmented mandarins and dried cranberries.
3. Gently mix ingredients together and serve.

Nutrition Tips & Substitution Options

- To make this recipe dairy-free, you can use a plant-based yogurt such as coconut, almond, or soy yogurt. You can also swap the Greek yogurt for some mashed avocado with a little bit of lemon juice. The lemon will provide a bit of a tangy flavor like the Greek yogurt, while the avocado will give it a rich, creamy texture and provide lots of healthy fats and fiber!

Cara Cara Fruit Sliders



Recipe by Stephanie Grasso, RD, Sunkist Collaborator



**Number of
servings: 2**



Prep time:
5 minutes

Approximate Nutrition Facts

Number of servings: 2

Serving size

3-5 fruit sliders

Calories	220
Total Fat	3g
Saturated Fat	1g
Cholesterol	9mg
Sodium	201mg
Total Carbohydrates	44g
Fiber	7g
Sugars	30g
Protein	8g

Known as the pink orange, Cara Cara oranges get their distinctive inner pink color from lycopene, an antioxidant that may help protect cells from damage caused by free radicals. Lycopene is also linked to improved heart and brain health, sunburn protection, and may even help slow tumor growth in some types of cancer, including breast cancer.^[9] These Cara Cara sliders are packed with vitamins and minerals and will make your day that much sweeter!

Ingredients

- 3 Cara Cara oranges
- 1/2 cup cottage cheese
- 1 fruit of choice, diced
- Basil for garnish (optional)

Instructions

1. Peel and cut Cara Cara oranges into 1/2-inch wheels.
2. Top wheels with cottage cheese and diced fruit of choice, such as strawberries, blueberries, kiwi, or mango.
3. Garnish with basil, if desired.

Nutrition Tips & Substitution Options

- To make this snack dairy-free, substitute the cottage cheese with a vegan cottage cheese, vegan yogurt, mashed avocado, or your choice of nut butter.



Dinner



Arroz con Pollo Bake (Chicken with Rice)



Recipe by Sunkist



**Number of
servings: 6**



Prep time:
10 minutes



Cook time:
45-50 minutes

Approximate Nutrition Facts

Number of servings: 6

Serving size

Approx. 2 cups

Calories	614
-----------------	------------

Total Fat	30g
------------------	-----

Saturated Fat	5g
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Cholesterol	70mg
--------------------	------

Sodium	1,779mg
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Total Carbohydrates	56g
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Fiber	2.3g
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Sugars	9g
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Protein	32g
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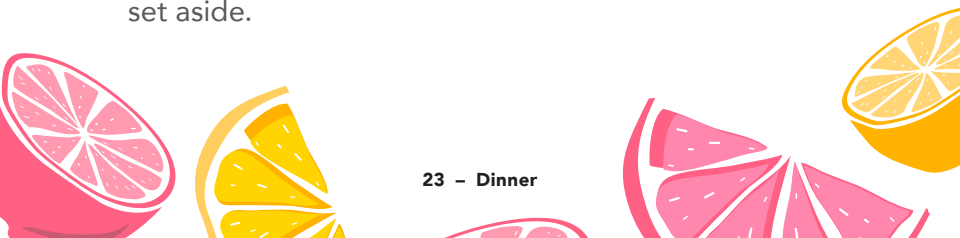
Vibrantly colored fruits and vegetables are generally very high in antioxidants, and this recipe is no exception! Full of flavor, this Chicken with Rice Bake is also full of nutrients such as lycopene and beta-carotene, antioxidants found in tomatoes that help protect cells, improve heart health, and may reduce the risk of developing cancer.^[8,9] Tomatoes also provide a lot of vitamin C in addition to that already found in the lemons and oranges. This tasty dish will leave you satisfied and knowing you are giving your body an extra boost of nutrients.

Ingredients

- 2 Meyer lemons, zested and juiced
- 2 cups freshly squeezed Cara Cara orange juice
- 1 10-ounce can diced tomatoes with green chilies
- 1 cup water
- 2 small diced onions
- 2 pounds chicken breast tenders
- 1 1-ounce package ranch dressing mix
- 2 Tbsp olive oil for cooking
- 1 1/2 cups converted (or parboiled) long-grain white rice
- Shredded cheese, sour cream, and/or avocado for toppings (optional)

Instructions

1. Preheat oven to 325° F.
2. Combine tomatoes, freshly squeezed lemon and orange juices, freshly grated zest, and water in a container and set aside.



3. Cut chicken tenders in half diagonally and then toss in a bowl with ranch dressing mix until well coated. Set aside.
4. Heat olive oil in a 3-quart oven-safe saucepan or Dutch oven over medium-high heat.
5. Add diced onion and sauté about 4 minutes, until just tender.
6. Add chicken and cook for 3 more minutes, stirring occasionally, then stir in uncooked rice.
7. Add tomato, lemon, and orange juice mixture and bring to a quick boil.
8. Cover tightly and bake in preheated oven for about 40 minutes, until rice is tender and chicken is fully cooked, reaching an internal temperature of 165° F.
9. Serve with shredded cheese, sour cream, and/or avocado, if desired.

Nutrition Tips & Substitution Options

- If you don't have ranch dressing mix, you can use 1 Tbsp regular ranch dressing or make your own similar dressing. See recipe in [Appendix](#).
- If you don't have converted/parboiled long-grain rice, you can always use regular white or brown rice instead. Keep in mind that brown rice may need to cook a little bit longer, and white rice may cook for a bit shorter time than what this recipe calls for.
 - » Converted/parboiled rice is a reference to how the rice was processed. Parboiled rice tends to be slightly higher in vitamins than regular white rice, though not as high in nutrients as brown rice.^[10]
- You can also substitute the chicken tenders for chicken breast for a healthier, lower-calorie, and lower-sodium option.

Sheet Pan Citrus Teriyaki Chicken



Recipe by Stephanie Grasso, RD, Sunkist Collaborator



**Number of
servings: 3**



Prep time:
10 minutes



Cook time:
30 minutes

Approximate Nutrition Facts

Number of servings: 3

Serving size

**2 chicken
tenderloins plus
approximately 1.5
cups vegetables**

Calories	323
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Total Fat	5g
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Saturated Fat	1g
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Cholesterol	77mg
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Sodium	1,985mg
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Total Carbohydrates	35g
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Fiber	5g
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Sugars	25g
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Protein	35g
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Sheet pan meals are an easy and efficient way to cook up a healthy meal by reducing steps and dishes. This sheet pan recipe is full of fresh, colorful vegetables. These colors come from the pigments in the food, which correspond to different antioxidants known as carotenoids, flavonoids, and anthocyanidins. These antioxidants can help protect cells from damage and therefore reduce the risk for developing cancer or recurrence.^[11]

Ingredients

Marinade Ingredients

- 1/2 cup freshly squeezed Cara Cara orange juice
- 1/2 cup teriyaki sauce
- 1/2 Tbsp orange zest
- 1 tsp ground ginger
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1 Tbsp honey
- Salt to taste

Citrus Teriyaki Chicken Ingredients

- 6 chicken tenderloins, approx. 1 lb total
- 1 red bell pepper, chopped
- 1/3 red onion, sliced
- 1 zucchini, chopped
- 4 oz broccoli florets
- 4 oz cauliflower florets
- 1 Tbsp sesame seeds
- 1 Cara Cara orange, sliced

Instructions

Marinade Instructions

1. Combine teriyaki sauce, orange juice, orange zest, ginger, garlic powder, honey, and salt.
2. Whisk until all ingredients are combined.

Citrus Teriyaki Chicken Instructions

1. Preheat the oven to 350° F.
2. In a separate bowl, combine chicken and vegetables. Pour in half of the marinade and toss mixture until evenly coated.
3. Spread mixture evenly on a baking sheet. Top chicken with sliced oranges. Bake in the oven for 24 minutes, flipping halfway through. Continue cooking until chicken and vegetables are tender. The chicken is done when it has reached an internal temperature of 165° F.
4. Pour remaining marinade over mixture. Top with sesame seeds and serve.

Nutrition Tips & Substitution Options

- Use low-sodium teriyaki sauce to lower the sodium level of this dish.
- You can also easily make this recipe meat-free by substituting the chicken for your choice of fish or firm tofu.
 - » If using fish, a white fish such as Mahi Mahi or cod will have the most similar texture and flavor to chicken, but options like salmon would also be delicious! Fish cooks a little bit faster than chicken, so expect it to only be in the oven about 15-18 minutes, depending on the thickness of the fish. For food safety, fish should be cooked until an internal temperature of 145° F is reached.

- » If making this recipe plant-based, try a “firm” tofu to maintain its shape. You will want to drain the liquid and press between two clean towels to remove excess moisture. Cut it into small, bite-sized pieces before adding in half the marinade from step #2. It is also best to increase the oven temperature to 425° F and cook for about 20 minutes.

Vegan Orange Tofu Lettuce Wraps



Recipe by by Jessica Bippen, RD, Sunkist Collaborator



**Number of
servings: 4**



Prep time:
10 minutes



Cook time:
25 minutes

Approximate Nutrition Facts

Number of servings: 4

Serving size

2-5 lettuce wraps,
depending on size
of lettuce

Calories	400
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Total Fat	7g
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Saturated Fat	1g
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Cholesterol	0mg
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Sodium	437mg
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Total Carbohydrates	70g
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Fiber	2g
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Sugars	10g
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Protein	14g
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This vegan recipe uses coconut aminos, a savory sauce that tastes similar to soy sauce but is a little sweeter. Coconut aminos, made from the fermented sap of coconut palm trees, are naturally soy-free and gluten-free, making them a great option for anyone with those dietary restrictions.^[12] Tofu is also a great, soy-based protein. Recent studies show that soy has many benefits for breast cancer and may be protective against its recurrence.^[13-18] Combined with the vitamin C found in the Cara Cara oranges (also known as the pink orange), these lettuce wraps are a healthy way to add some crispness to your diet!

Ingredients

Tofu Lettuce Wrap Ingredients

- 1 14-ounce package extra-firm or super-firm tofu, drained
- 1 Tbsp coconut aminos
- 1 Tbsp cornstarch or arrowroot starch, divided
- 1 head of Little Gem, iceberg, or butterhead lettuce leaves
- 2 cups cooked white jasmine rice, cooked to package specifications
- 1 thinly sliced green onion
- 1 Tbsp Sesame seeds

Orange Sauce Ingredients

- 1 cup fresh Cara Cara orange juice
- Zest of one Cara Cara orange
- 1/3 cup coconut aminos
- 2 Tbsp rice vinegar
- 1 tsp sesame oil

1/2 inch fresh grated ginger, grated on microplane (or
1/4 tsp ground ginger)

2 garlic cloves, minced (or 1/2 tsp garlic powder)

Red pepper flakes, to taste

1 Tbsp cornstarch or arrowroot starch

Instructions

Tofu Lettuce Wrap Instructions

1. If using extra-firm tofu, press the tofu to remove the moisture. Wrap tofu in a kitchen towel or paper towels and place a heavy pan on top. Let drain for at least 15 minutes. Unwrap tofu and cut into 1-inch cubes. If using super-firm tofu, simply pat with a paper towel and cut into 1-inch cubes.
2. Preheat oven to 425° F and line a baking sheet with parchment paper.
3. Add cubed tofu to a large bowl, drizzle with coconut aminos, and toss to coat.
4. Sprinkle cornstarch or arrowroot starch over the tofu and gently toss until coated.
5. Spread tofu evenly onto baking sheet. Bake for 20-25 minutes or until golden and crisp around the edges.
6. Once the tofu has about 10 minutes left to bake, create the orange sauce (steps below).
7. Add cooked rice to each lettuce cup and top with orange tofu. Garnish each cup with sesame seeds, sliced green onions, and red pepper flakes, if desired. Serve immediately.
8. Store leftover orange tofu in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to 4 days.

Orange Sauce Instructions

1. In a small bowl, whisk together orange juice and zest, coconut aminos, rice vinegar, garlic, ginger, sesame oil, chili flakes (optional), and cornstarch.
2. Heat a large skillet over medium heat.
3. Once hot, pour orange sauce in the skillet and bring to a low boil. Let thicken for 3-5 minutes.
4. Once the sauce thickens, add tofu and toss to thoroughly coat in sauce. Remove skillet from heat.

Nutrition Tips & Substitution Options

- This recipe can be made with cubed chicken or salmon in place of tofu.
 - » If using cubed chicken, preheat the oven to 350° F and bake for approximately 20-25 minutes until the internal temperature reaches 165° F.
 - » If using cubed salmon, preheat the oven to 400° F and bake for approximately 12-15 minutes until the internal temperature reaches 145° F.
- If you don't have coconut aminos, you can also use low-sodium soy sauce or tamari (which is gluten-free) in its place.

Appendix:

Homemade Ranch Dressing

Referenced in [Arroz con Pollo \(Chicken with Rice\) Bake](#) recipe

1 Tbsp of plain Greek yogurt or sour cream

1/4 tsp of dried parsley

1/8 tsp dried dill

1/8 tsp garlic powder

1/8 tsp onion powder

A pinch of salt and black pepper

A small squeeze of lemon juice

A drop of white vinegar

Combine all ingredients and mix together.

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Medical Review

All information and recipes in this cookbook have been reviewed by registered dietitian, Annie Cavalier, MS, RDN, LD.

About Annie Cavalier, MS, RDN, LD



Annie Cavalier is a clinical registered dietitian who works at one of the largest hospitals in Dallas, Texas. She attended the University of Texas at Austin for her bachelor's degree in nutrition and dietetics and received her master's degree in nutrition from Texas Woman's University. Annie's interest in nutrition was sparked when she was 12 years old and her mother was diagnosed with breast

cancer. With the help of a friend who is a chef, Annie's family learned how to prepare healthy, delicious food that her mother was able to eat during treatment. Noticing how much of an impact food and nutrition had on overall health and wellbeing, Annie set out to learn more about the science behind food and its relationship to health.

Annie runs her own nutrition and lifestyle website, My Healthful Life, which she plans to grow into a private practice. In addition to writing articles for her own website, Annie has also written for the University of Texas Department of Kinesiology's Fitness Institute of Texas, Southern Dallas Magazine, and more.

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